Comparatives and superlatives

Nombre: _____ Fecha: _____

Qué vas a aprender

- Compare two things with comparatives: taller than, more expensive than
- Say which is the top one in a group with superlatives: the tallest, the most expensive
- Use the irregular forms good, bad and far
- Compare people, animals and places in short texts

Para pensar

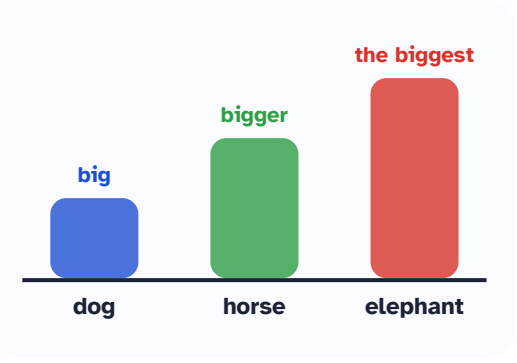
Un guepardo es más rápido que un caballo. Pero ¿cuál es el animal terrestre más rápido de todos? ¿Cómo dirías «más rápido que» y «el más rápido» en inglés?

Explicación

Comparing two or more

When we compare **two** things we use the comparative: «A horse is **bigger than** a dog». When we choose the **number one** in a group of three or more we use the superlative: «The elephant is **the biggest** of the three».

En castellano: el comparativo es «más... que» y el superlativo es «el más... de». En inglés, el adjetivo cambia: big → bigger → the biggest. Detrás del comparativo va **than** («que») y delante del superlativo va **the**.



Short adjectives: -er and -est

Adjectives with **one syllable** add -er and -est: tall → tall**er** → the tall**est**; fast → faster → the fastest; old → older → the oldest; small → smaller → the smallest.

Spelling: ending in -e, add only -r / -st: nice → nicer → the nicest. Consonant + vowel + consonant, double the letter: big → bi**gg**er → the bi**gg**est; hot → hotter → the hottest; thin → thinner → the thinnest.

Adjective	Comparative	Superlative
tall	taller	the tallest
nice	nicer	the nicest
big	bigger	the biggest
hot	hotter	the hottest

Adjectives ending in -y

Adjectives with two syllables that end in **-y** change the y to -ier and -iest: happy → happ**ier** → the happ**iest**; funny → funnier → the funniest; easy → easier → the easiest; heavy → heavier → the heaviest.

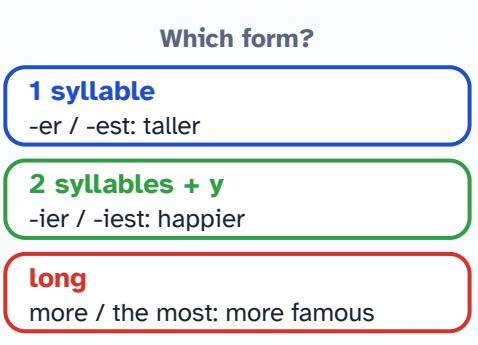
Example: «My cat is **lazier than** my dog, but my hamster is **the laziest** pet in the house!». **En castellano:** es la misma regla de la y que en el pasado (study → studied): la y se convierte en i.

Adjective	Comparative	Superlative
happy	happier	the happiest
funny	funnier	the funniest
easy	easier	the easiest

Long adjectives: more and the most

Long adjectives (two or more syllables, not ending in -y) don't change. We put more or the most before them: interesting → **more interesting** → **the most interesting**; expensive → more expensive → the most expensive; beautiful, dangerous, important, popular...

«A tiger is **more dangerous than** a cat». «The blue whale is **the most amazing** animal I know». Never mix the two forms: not «more bigger» or «the most fastest».



Irregular forms

Three very common adjectives are irregular: **good → better → the best**; **bad → worse → the worst**; **far → further → the furthest**.

«This pizza is **better than** the last one». «It was **the best** day of my life!». «Monday is **the worst** day of the week». **En castellano:** también en español son irregulares: bueno → mejor (no «más bueno»), malo → peor. Por eso en inglés nunca se dice «gooder» ni «the goodest».

Adjective	Comparative	Superlative
good	better	the best
bad	worse	the worst
far	further	the furthest

Superlatives in sentences

After a superlative we often say the group with in (places, groups) or of (a number or time): «Mount Everest is **the highest** mountain **in** the world», «Ana is **the tallest** girl **in** my class», «It's **the coldest** day **of** the year».

We can also use the present perfect phrase **I've ever** (que he... nunca): «It's **the best** book **I've ever read**». **En castellano:** «el mejor libro que he leído nunca».

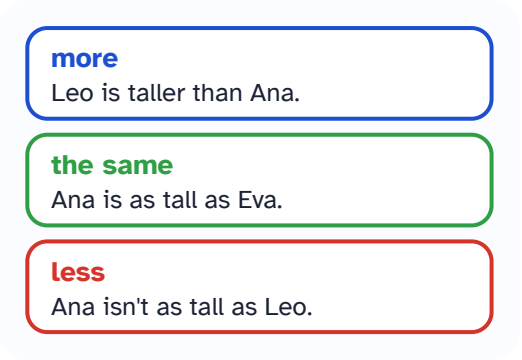


the + -est + in / of

As ... as: the same

To say two things are **equal** (iguales) we use as + adjective + as: «My brother is **as tall as** my dad». In the negative, not as ... as means «less»: «A bike isn't **as fast as** a car».

Compare these sentences, they mean the same: «A car is **faster than** a bike» = «A bike is**n't as fast as** a car». **En castellano:** «as... as» es «tan... como». El adjetivo va en su forma normal, sin -er.



Reading: world records

Read about animal records: «The **biggest** animal in the world is the blue whale. It is **heavier than** thirty elephants! The cheetah is **the fastest** land animal: it is **faster than** a car in the city. The giraffe is **the tallest** animal, and its tongue is **longer than** your arm. Tortoises are **slower than** most animals, but some live **longer than** people. Which animal do you think is **the most interesting**?»



Let's practise: class records

Make a **class record book** in groups. Measure and ask: «Who is **the tallest**?», «Who has **the longest** name?», «Who lives **the furthest** from school?». Write the results: «Pablo is the tallest. His name is shorter than Alejandro's».

Then compare two places you know: your town and a big city. «My town is **smaller** and **quieter than** Barcelona, but Barcelona is **more exciting**». **Consejo:** cuenta las sílabas del adjetivo antes de elegir -er o more.

Ana: Who is the tallest?

Pau: Pablo is the tallest.

Ana: Who lives the furthest?

Pau: Sara does. She lives in a farm.

Comparatives and superlatives

1 syllable	ending in -y	long	irregular
-ER / -EST	**-IER**	**MORE / MOST**	**BETTER**
taller the tallest	happier the happiest	more famous the most famous	the best worse, the worst

Ejercicios

1. **Write the comparative: cold, nice, big, happy.**

2. **Write the superlative: small, funny, expensive, good.**

3. **Complete: «A mouse is (small) ___ a cat.»**

4. **Complete: «August is (hot) ___ month of the year.»**

5. **Complete: «Football is (popular) ___ handball in Spain.»**

6. **Correct: «My bike is more good than yours.»**

7. **Rewrite with as ... as: «Tom is 12. Ana is 12.» (old)**

8. **Rewrite with not as ... as: «A car is faster than a bike.»**

9. **Translate: «Es el peor día de la semana.»**

10. **Compare three animals in three sentences.**

Practica

1. **The comparative of «tall» is...**
   - **A)** more tall
   - **B)** taller
   - **C)** tallest
2. **The superlative of «big» is...**
   - **A)** the bigest
   - **B)** the most big
   - **C)** the biggest
3. **The comparative of «easy» is...**
   - **A)** easier
   - **B)** easyer
   - **C)** more easy
4. **The superlative of «beautiful» is...**
   - **A)** the beautifulest
   - **B)** the more beautiful
   - **C)** the most beautiful
5. **The comparative of «good» is...**
   - **A)** gooder
   - **B)** better
   - **C)** best
6. **The superlative of «bad» is...**
   - **A)** the worst
   - **B)** the baddest
   - **C)** the worse
7. **«Spain is bigger ___ Portugal.»**
   - **A)** that
   - **B)** than
   - **C)** as
8. **«It's the longest river ___ Spain.»**
   - **A)** of

B) than

C) in

9. **«Tan rápido como» is...**

A) as fast as

B) so fast than

C) as faster as

10. **Which sentence is correct?**

A) He is funniest boy in class.

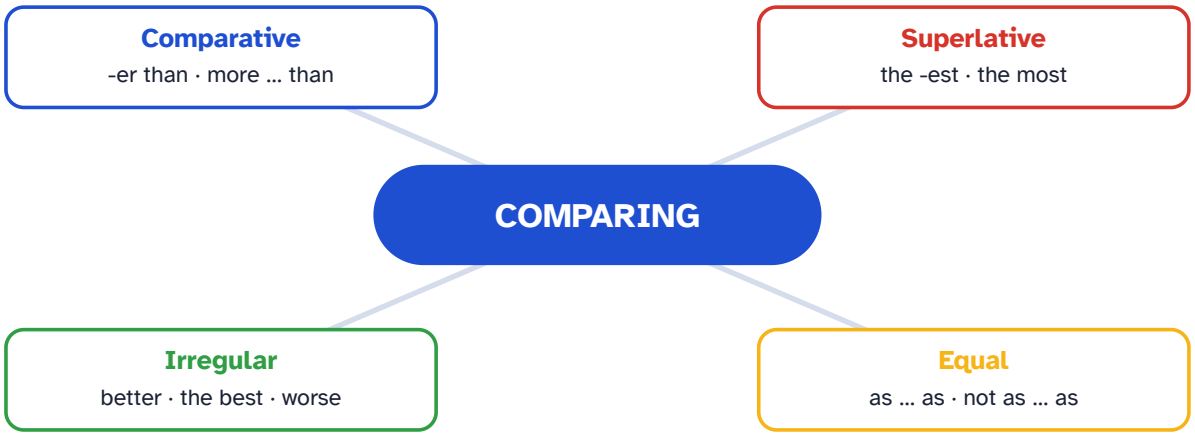
B) He is the funniest boy in class.

C) He is the most funny boy in class.

Explícalo con tus palabras

Incluye: Diferencia entre comparativo y superlativo; Cuándo se usa -er/-est y cuándo more/the most; Cuáles son los irregulares good, bad y far; Cómo se dice «tan... como» en inglés.

Resumen



Tarjetas de repaso

Recórtalas: pregunta delante, respuesta detrás.

-er than

Comparativo de adjetivos cortos.

the -est

Superlativo de adjetivos cortos.

-ier / -iest

Adjetivos en -y: happier, the happiest.

more / the most

Adjetivos largos.

better / the best

Comparativo y superlativo de good.

worse / the worst

Comparativo y superlativo de bad.

in / of

the tallest in the class · of the year.

as … as

Tan … como.

Soluciones

1. **B)** Una sílaba: -er.
2. **C)** Se dobla la g.
3. **A)** -y → -ier.
4. **C)** Adjetivo largo.
5. **B)** Irregular.
6. **A)** Irregular.
7. **B)** Comparativo + than.
8. **C)** Lugar: in.
9. **A)** as ... as.
10. **B)** the + -iest.

Soluciones de los ejercicios

1. colder, nicer, bigger, happier.
2. the smallest, the funniest, the most expensive, the best.
3. smaller than.
4. the hottest.
5. more popular than.
6. My bike is better than yours.
7. Tom is as old as Ana.
8. A bike isn't as fast as a car.
9. It's the worst day of the week.
10. Model answer: A dog is bigger than a cat. A horse is faster than a dog. The elephant is the heaviest of the three.